

SELF-LOADING PISTOLS (1946–80)

In the years following World War II, the design of self-loading handguns more or less followed the patterns set down earlier. By the 1970s, however, these pistols began to take on more streamlined profiles such as those seen in Heckler and Koch's VP70M. At the same time, components made from investment castings—wax models placed in molds so that finely detailed castings can be produced in metal—began to appear. Concurrently, plastic became the material of choice for pistol grips due to its stability in all weather conditions.



▲ M20 SILENCED

Date 1950s

Origin China

Barrel 9in (23cm) (including silencer)

Caliber 7.62 × 25mm

The M20 was a Chinese copy of the Soviet 7.62 × 25mm Tokarev TT Model 1933 (see p.174). It differed from the original in having more slide grip cuts. The model here features a suppressor (silencer).



◀ MAKAROV PM

Date 1950s

Origin Soviet Union

Barrel 3¼in (9.7cm)

Caliber 9mm Makarov

The Tokarev TT Model 33 (see p.174) was replaced by this copy of the Walther PP as the Red Army's standard sidearm. It was a double-action weapon and had a two-stage safety device. Its ammunition was about as powerful as could safely be used in a recoil design at that time.

Serial number



▲ HELWAN

Date 1965

Origin Egypt

Barrel 4¼in (11cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The Helwan is an Egyptian licensed version of the Beretta Model 1951 Brigadier, a single-action (the hammer has to be cocked manually) 9mm automatic handgun with an eight-round magazine capacity.

▲ TYPE 67

Date 1968

Origin China

Barrel 3½in (8.9cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 17mm

The Type 67 was a recoil pistol with an integral suppressor, or silencer. It featured a manual slide locking system, which stopped ejection of the spent cartridge after firing, making the pistol quieter during operation.